

Judaism

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JUDAISM

M:

A BRIEF OUTLINE OF ITS
HISTORY

The Period of

"Pre-History":

Here belong the early Biblical figures who appear in narratives of legendary **and/or** mythical form. Dating in this period is extremely difficult and **most** current scholars do not attempt any **fixed scheme**.

II. The **Age** of the Patriarchs (ca. 2000 to 1300
B.C.E.)

III

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IV

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V

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Abraham

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Isaac

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Jacob Joseph

This Age: Nomadic **tribes** of **Semites** wandering in the area of
Palestine. **Bondage** in Egypt:

(ca. 1750-1290)

The Age of Moses (ca. 1300-1200

B.C.E.)

Moses

Joshu

a

The Exodus from Egypt (ca. 1290) Wanderings in Sinai

wilderness. Traditional period

for the giving of the "Law."

Beginning of the conquest.

The Age of the Judges (1200-1020

B.C.E.)

Gideon Deborah

Samso

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Continuing struggle to occupy
Palestine. Leadership comes from
religious-military "charismatic"
figures.

The United Kingdom (ca. 1020-922

B.C.E.)

Saul, King

1020-1000

David, King

1000-961 Solomon,

King 961-922

Consolidation of occupation of Palestine.
United Kingdom reaches its greatest power
under David. This Davidic reign later
idealized as the great period of the
nation.

VI

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The Divided

Kingdom:

(ca.
922-722)
Israel (Northern
Kingdom)

Judah (Southern
Kingdom)
(ca.
922-587)

Rulers: A series of **nineteen** kings Rulers: A series of twenty
kings,

note

especially:

note

especially:

Rehoboam
(922-915)

Uzziah
(793-742)

Jeroboam I
(922-901)

Omri
(876-869)

Ahab (969-850)

Jehu (842-815)

Prophets:

(Selected)

Elijah (fl.
370)

Amos (fl.
740)

Hosea (fl.
735)

722 B.C.E. Northern Kingdom
falls

to Assyria. Deportation of Hebrews
to Mesopotamia.

Josiah
(640-609)
Zedekiah
(598-587)

Prophets:
(Selected)

Isaiah (fl.
725)
Micah (fl. 710)
Jeremiah (fl.
600)
Ezekiel (fl.
585)

587 B.C.E. Southern Kingdom falls to Babylonia and Jews **deported** to
Babylon.

The **Age** of the Babylonian Exile and the **Return** Under Persia
(587-332)

Important figures and
events:

Ezekiel (fl.
585)
"Second" Isaiah (fl.
540)
539 B.C.E. Cyrus (Persia)
captures
Babylon. Allows Jews to
return
to homeland. A few do
so.

The
times:
Jews "settle down" in
Babylonia. **Some** look forward
to day of
retur

n.
Messianic thought
develops.

VII

- 520-516, the Jerusalem Temple rebuilt.
Nehemiah, (fl. 440) Ezra, (fl. 400)

Synagogue developed in exile
and place of worship.
Converts to Judaism develop.
Influence of Persian
(Zoroastrian) thought on
Judaism.
Pentateuch reaches final form, ca. 400.

VIII. Greek Period and Into Roman Period (332-B.C.E.-70 C.E.)

IX

- Figures and Events:

332 B.C.E., Alexander conquers
Persian armies and controls
Palestine.

Book of Daniel written.

Jewish self-rule under the
Maccabean Line
(165-63)

63 B.C.E., Rome annexes Palestine.
Herod the Great rules the Jews
(37-4
B.C.E.)

Birth of Jesus (ca. 6-4 B.C.E.) 66
C.E., Jews rebel against Rome. 70
C.E., Roman legions under Titus.
devastate Jerusalem. Sadducees, as
a party, cease to exist.

The Talmudic Age (70-500
C.E.)

Events:

90 C.E., Council of Jamnia;
where Jewish scriptures. (Old
Testament) is proclaimed
authoritative

132-135 C.E., Bar Cochba rebellion

Emperor Hadrian orders Jews to be
butchered into submission.
Jews no longer allowed into
Jerusalem.

ca. 220 C.E., Mishna edited
and
promulgated by Rabbi
Judah.
the Prince

ca. 499 C.E., Babylonian Talmud
finished.

X. The Medieval Age and on (500-1800 C.E.)

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The

Times:

Greek culture influences
Palestine. This resisted by the
"loyal" Jew. Apocalyptic thought
develops. Messianic thought grows.

Jewish sects and parties
develop:

Pharisees

Sadducees

Essene

s

Zealots

Jewish settlements in most cities
of the Roman Empire.

The Times:

Rabbis (Pharisees) became the
leaders of Judaism. As:

Hillel (died 10 C.E.)

Gamaliel (fl. 35
C.E.)

Yohanan Ben Zakkai (fl. 70 C.E.) Akiba (died ca. 135 C.E.) Meir (died ca. 160 C.E.)

Judah the Prince (160-220
C.E.)

Mishna, Gemara, and Talmud
developed.

Christians **seek** to win all Jews to
Christianit
y.

Development of legal traditions in an attempt **to** apply the Law to
everyday life. **Commentaries** on scripture and **Talmud** developed.

Jewish philosophy developed under influence of Islamic culture.
Concerned with the relating of reason and religious **faith**.

C. Jewish mystical tradition
developed.

(Kabbala
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Some representative great scholars:

Ibn **Gabirol** (1001-1052)

Judah Halevi
(1030-1140)

Moses Maimonides
(1135-1204).

A

E.

#F.

Persecution and martyrdom of Jews by Christians, especially
around centuries **of** the Crusades. (**ca.** 1096-1274)

Thi
s

Hassidim founded by Israel **Baal Shem Tov** (**ca.** 1725).

emphasized the **pietistic, mystical** way to God.
Stressed joy **in** living and **fervor in** prayer.

XI

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The Modern Age (1800

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present)

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Three **reactions to** the Enlightenment (Haskalah)

1. Orthodox Judaism.

2.

3

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Reformed

Judaism.

Conservative

Judaism.

Zionism: A **nationalistic** movement calling for a return
to Palestine and the **development** of a new **nation of**
Israel.

Theodore Herzl the formative **leader** (fl. 1896). 1948,
the State of Israel established in **Palestine**.